

This brings us to ask what tests we should apply to determine the presence of elements due to Zarathushtra's Reform. We saw in the last Lecture that the worship of Ahura Mazda must be abandoned for this purpose, however reluctantly, since there is conclusive reason to believe that he was adored in a tribe which could contribute to the Assyrian pantheon centuries before the earliest possible epoch for Zarathushtra's mission. The sacrifice of this test is a most serious complication in our problem, and may even preclude the possibility of any really decisive solution. But in the case of Darius we have really strong evidence to support the conclusion of Prof. Geldner that "Darius and his successors were without doubt devoted adherents of Zoroastrianism."¹ Meyer's difficulty as to a religious innovation is met by E. W. West's proof that Darius probably reformed the Calendar in a Zoroastrian direction; see *SBE*, xlvii. pp. xliii-xlvii. That Darius was a fervent worshipper of Auramazda may not prove Zarathushtra's influence, but it is of course consistent with it. But what of his failure to mention Zarathushtra himself, Angra Mainyu, and the Amesha Spenta? The first omission is intelligible enough, if the Prophet was a figure of the distant past, but not yet elevated (by Magian theology) into a supernatural being. Taking the Gathas as generally representative of Darius's religion, we might fairly say that the omission is no stranger than that of Paul's name would be in a historical rescript by some pious medieval king, perpetually ascribing his triumphs to the grace of "God and Our Lady," but silent about the Apostles, to whose writings he would of course

¹ *Enc. Brit.*, s.v. "Zoroaster."